Count the room before filling the week

Keep categories separate. Do not count the same meeting or task twice. Hours are estimates to review, not targets to fill.

37.5	-12	-6	-4.5	=15
Working hours	Fixed commitments	Team support / admin	Contingency	Delivery capacity

Example: 21 hours of deliverables - 15 hours available = 6 hours to resolve.

MY WEEK	Hours	Check
Working time, after leave and non-working breaks		Use your actual agreed hours.
Minus fixed meetings / commitments		Only count commitments you will retain.
Minus support / routine work		Make team leadership time visible.
Minus contingency for uncertainty		Choose using your context; 4.5 is an example, not a rule.
Equals capacity for planned deliverables		If negative, commitments already exceed the week.

If estimates vary, use a range and test the higher estimate. Never turn the gap into unagreed overtime.

Write your workload discussion script

Keep the facts specific. Bring a recommendation and leave space for information that changes the plan.

1 The work / What has been requested or agreed?

2 The gap / Hours, deadlines or dependencies that collide

3 Two options / What changes, what stays, and the consequence?

4 My recommendation / The decision I need and by when

5 A question I will ask / One thing that could change my view

6 Agreed next step / Owner / Date / Who needs an update

Say the opening aloud once. Shorten it until someone can understand the choice without reading your whole task list.

Your one-page workweek plan

Week of: _____ Review date: _____

CAPACITY / Working hours - fixed work - support - contingency = delivery hours

PRIORITY 1 / Output, done means and date

PRIORITY 2 / Output, done means and date

PRIORITY 3, IF IT FITS / Or leave room

FOCUS / When, what, and the urgent contact route

TRADE-OFF / What moves, who agrees, who needs to know

SUPPORT / Team windows, hand-offs and dependencies

REVIEW / What changed? What is the next decision?